

ECHOES

CD23731 - FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

ISAITAMIL S

231701021

in partial fulfillment for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING

in

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND DESIGN



RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE

ANNA UNIVERSITY, CHENNAI

SEPTEMBER 2026

RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE

ANNA UNIVERSITY, CHENNAI

BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this Report titled is the Bonafide work of ISAITAMIL S (231701021) who carried out the work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported herein does not form part of any other thesis or dissertation on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or any other candidate.

Signature of the Supervisor

Dr. Gunasekar

Assistant Professor

Department of Computer Science and
Design

Rajalakshmi Engineering College

Submitted to the CD23721 - Film Making and Radio Podcasting Examination held on

.....

Signature of Internal Examiner

Signature of External Examiner

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Initially we thank the Almighty for being with us through every walk of our life and showering his blessings through the endeavor to put forth this report. Our sincere thanks to our Chairman **Mr. S. MEGANATHAN, B.E, F.I.E.**, our Vice Chairman **Mr. ABHAY SHANKAR MEGANATHAN, B.E., M.S.**, and our respected Chairperson **Dr. (Mrs.) THANGAM MEGANATHAN, Ph.D.**, for providing us with the requisite infrastructure and sincere endeavoring in educating us in their premier institution.

Our sincere thanks to **Dr. S.N. MURUGESAN, M.E., Ph.D.**, our beloved Principal for his kind support and facilities provided to complete our work in time. We express our sincere thanks to **Dr. VINODHKUMAR S, Ph.D.**, Professor and Head of the Department of Computer Science and Design for his guidance and encouragement throughout the project work. We convey our sincere and deepest gratitude to our internal guide, **Dr. GUNASEKAR**, Department of Computer Science and Design. Rajalakshmi Engineering College for her valuable guidance throughout the course of the project.

ISAITAMIL S (231701021)

ANNEXURE III

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Chapter / Section	Title	Page No.
CHAPTER 1	INTRODUCTION	1
1.1	About the Film	1
1.2	Background	1
1.3	Theme and Message	2
CHAPTER 2	STORY & CHARACTERS	3
2.1	Story Synopsis	3
2.2	Main Characters	3
2.3	Character Development	4
2.4	Message	4
2.5	Use of the Time-Loop Concept	4
2.6	Symbolism of the Pocket Watch	5
2.7	Emotional Progression	5
CHAPTER 3	PRE-PRODUCTION	6
3.1	Script Development	6
3.2	Scene Planning	6
3.3	Locations	7

3.4	Cast and Crew	7
3.5	Production Planning	7
CHAPTER 4	PRODUCTION	8
4.1	Shooting Process	8
4.2	Camera	8
4.3	Lighting	9
4.4	Audio	9
4.5	Direction	9
CHAPTER 5	POST-PRODUCTION	10
5.1	Video Editing	10
5.2	Sound and Music	10
5.3	Colour Correction	10
5.4	Titles and Final Presentation	11
CHAPTER 6	CONCLUSION	12
6.1	Final Outcome	12
6.2	Challenges Faced	12
6.3	Learning Outcomes	13
6.4	Overall Conclusion	13
APPENDICES		14

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 About the Film

“Echoes” is a short film that combines elements of psychological drama, fantasy, and self-reflection. The film addresses a familiar problem among young people today — gaming addiction and the isolation that comes with it.

The story follows a young man who spends his evenings immersed in online competitive games. What begins as a hobby gradually turns into an obsession. As exhaustion and isolation build up, the boundary between reality and the digital world begins to blur. A sudden white flash throws him into an unknown place where a mysterious hooded Guide confronts him with the consequences of his choices.

The Guide tells him that every choice leaves an echo and every obsession leaves a mark. Faced with this realization, the young man reflects on the time and life he has neglected and rises with the determination to change.

The film was created as a student filmmaking project using limited resources. The production focused on showing how an engaging narrative can be built through storytelling, performance, camera framing, editing, and sound rather than expensive equipment or locations.

1.2 Background

The main objective of the project was to obtain practical experience in the complete filmmaking process, beginning with an original story idea and ending with a completed short film.

The project provided experience in:

- Developing a short-film concept.
- Writing a screenplay and dialogue.
- Planning scenes and locations.

- Directing actors.
- Operating a smartphone camera.
- Maintaining continuity between repeated scenes.
- Editing video and audio.
- Adding sound effects and background music.
- Applying basic colour correction.
- Presenting a complete narrative within a limited duration.

1.3 Theme and Message

The central theme of “Echoes” is obsession and self-neglect: the way an unchecked habit can pull a person away from real life until they lose themselves in it.

The mysterious Guide and the unknown location act as a visual representation of the young man's inner conflict. He is not being punished by an outside force; he is being asked to face himself. The film therefore presents the idea that the choices we repeat leave marks that we eventually have to answer for.

The message of the film is:

“Every choice leaves an echo. You can keep running... or face yourself.”

The final resolution reinforces this idea by showing that the loop ends only when Vishwa takes action.

CHAPTER 2

STORY & CHARACTERS

2.1 Story Synopsis

The film opens on a quiet morning. A hand drops a tea bag into a cup of hot water, and the day begins normally. In the evening, a young man sits in front of his computer in a gaming room lit by neon lights. He starts an online match and becomes deeply focused. A fast montage of fingers on the keyboard, urgent mouse clicks, and flashing game visuals ends with the words “MATCH FOUND”.

Exhausted, he collapses onto his bed at night, the pressure of competition and isolation visible on his face. The next morning, he steps outside, but the atmosphere feels different. Strange sounds and subtle visual distortions suggest that something is wrong. Back at the computer, he keeps playing, and the line between reality and the digital world starts to blur.

A white flash breaks reality, followed by a black screen and a subtitled voice: “I'm the guide here.” In an unknown location, a hooded figure waits. The Guide tells him, “You've been chasing victories, but you've lost yourself in the echoes.” Confused, he listens as the Guide explains that every choice leaves an echo and every obsession leaves a mark. The world shifts again and he finds himself in an open field. Overwhelmed, he falls to his knees and reflects on his actions, his time, and the life he has neglected. He slowly rises, determined to change.

2.2 Main Characters

Name	Role
Zaidh	Actor — Zaidh
Bhoobanraj	Actor — Bhoobanraj
Nishanth	Cameraman
Isaitamil	Director & Writer

2.3 Character Development

The Young Man undergoes the most significant development during the film. At the beginning, he is absorbed in the game and treats it as harmless entertainment. As exhaustion and isolation grow, he becomes restless and disconnected from the world around him.

In the final stage, he stops running from the situation and faces himself. This change represents the main character development of the film: from obsession to awareness and action

2.4 Message

The film communicates that an obsession left unchecked can slowly consume a person's time, health, and relationships. The blurring of the gaming world and the real world gives this idea a visual and dramatic form.

The closing moment of the young man rising in the open field connects the fictional journey to a real-life experience, showing that it is never too late to reflect and change direction.

2.5 Use of the Time-Loop Concept

The blurring of reality is the primary storytelling device used in the film. Rather than giving a complicated fantasy explanation, the film communicates it through subtle sound distortions, visual glitches, the “MATCH FOUND” message, and the sudden white flash.

The film moves through clearly different worlds: the ordinary room, the neon-lit gaming room, the changed world outside, and finally the unknown location. This creates two layers in the story. The external world gradually becomes unstable, while the protagonist's internal understanding continues to develop. This contrast helps show that the real conflict is inside the young man.

2. Symbolism of the Echo

The echo is the central symbol of the film. It represents the lasting effect of repeated choices and habits. Several visual elements support this idea:.

- The tea cup: the calm opening image of an ordinary routine, before the obsession takes over.
- Neon lights: the artificial and isolating world of the game.
- The white flash: the moment when reality breaks and the protagonist is forced to stop.
- The hooded Guide: the protagonist's own conscience, given a face. - The open field: space, freedom, and the possibility of starting again.

2.7 Emotional Progression

The protagonist's emotions were designed to change progressively throughout the film.

Stage	Young man Emotional State
Morning routine	Calm and ordinary
Gaming session	Focused and absorbed
Bedroom at night	Exhausted and isolated
Outside the house	Uneasy and disoriented
Blurring of reality	Confused and overwhelmed
Meeting the Guide	Confused and questioning
Open field	Regretful, then determined

This progression gives the film a clear emotional arc, moving from routine to obsession, from crisis to realization, and finally to resolve.

CHAPTER 3

PRE-PRODUCTION

3.1 Script Development

The script was written by Isaitamil. The initial idea was developed around the phrase “Every choice leaves an echo.”

The story was designed to remain simple enough to be produced with limited resources while still having an interesting narrative structure. Instead of requiring many locations or a large cast, the screenplay focuses on one main character, one supporting character, and a small number of settings.

Special attention was given to the transitions between the real and unreal worlds, because these transitions are essential to communicating the blurring of reality.

3.2 Scene Planning

The scenes were planned around the major stages of the story:

1. Morning routine: the tea cup and tea bag.
2. Gaming room: the young man starts an online match.
3. Gaming montage and “MATCH FOUND”.
4. Bedroom at night: exhaustion and isolation.
5. Exterior of the house: strange sounds and visual distortions.
6. Return to the gaming room: reality begins to blur.
7. White flash and black screen: “I’m the guide here.”
8. Unknown location: meeting with the Guide.
9. Open field: reflection and determination to change.
10. Fade out and “The End”.

This structure helped maintain a clear beginning, middle, and ending within the fourminute runtime..

3.3 Locations

- Room (morning scene)
- Gaming room (neon-lit setup) - Bedroom
- House exterior Gateway / Entrance

Using existing locations reduced production requirements and allowed the team to concentrate more on performance, framing, atmosphere, and storytelling.

3.5 Production Planning

Since the film moves between several distinct moods and places, consistency was an important part of the planning process. The team planned the look of each world in advance: warm and ordinary for the opening room, cool neon for the gaming room, slightly unsettling for the exterior, and open and calm for the final field.

Actors were guided during production based on the requirements of each scene. The direction focused on gradually changing the protagonist's expressions as his obsession deepened and, later, as he confronted himself

CHAPTER 4

PRODUCTION

4.1 Shooting Process

The shooting was completed over **two days** across the planned locations. The production followed the screenplay and focused on capturing the important narrative moments without unnecessary scenes. The repeated sequences required careful attention because even small continuity differences could make the time-loop confusing for the audience.

Multiple takes were recorded whenever required, particularly for scenes involving repeated dialogue, actor movement, and the pocket watch.

4.2 Camera

The entire film was recorded using a **smartphone camera** mounted on a tripod.

The tripod provided stable framing and helped maintain similar compositions between repeated scenes. This was particularly useful for the doorway scenes and watch insert shots.

The production demonstrated that a smartphone can be used to create a complete short-film project when the camera placement, composition, and storytelling are carefully planned.

4.3 Lighting

No external lighting equipment was used. The team worked with available natural and room lighting.

The lighting was kept relatively simple because the primary focus of the film was on the characters and the progression of the story. Consistency of lighting was considered when shooting repeated scenes so that the loops could appear visually connected..

4.4 Audio

The phone's built-in microphone was used for recording the dialogue. Additional sound elements were incorporated during post-production.

The repeated **beep/time-reset sound** became an important audio cue because it helps the audience recognize when the time-loop occurs..

4.5 Direction

Harish directed the film with a hands-on approach. Since formal rehearsals were not conducted, the actors were guided directly during shooting.

The direction concentrated on Vishwa's changing emotional state. His performance was gradually adjusted across the loops:

Casual → Confused → Suspicious → Frustrated → Determined

This progression helps the audience understand that although the external events remain similar, Vishwa's understanding of the situation is changing.

.

CHAPTER 5

POST-PRODUCTION

5.1 Video Editing

The complete film was edited using **CapCut**. The editing process involved:

- Selecting suitable takes.
- Trimming unnecessary footage.
- Arranging scenes according to the screenplay.
- Creating the repeated-loop structure.
- Adding watch insert shots.
- Creating CUT TO BLACK transitions.
- Maintaining the pace of the four-minute film.

The editing was particularly important because the time-loop concept depends on the audience recognizing repeated events while also noticing the changes in Vishwa's behaviour.

5.2 Sound and Music

Background music and sound effects were incorporated during editing. Audio elements were sourced from YouTube's royalty-free/audio library and arranged using CapCut.

The reset beep was used as a recurring sound cue to indicate the transition between one loop and another. Background music was used to support the emotional and mysterious portions of the film.

5.3 Colour Correction

Basic colour correction and grading were performed using CapCut's built-in adjustment tools. The purpose was to maintain a reasonably consistent appearance between shots recorded at different times and under different lighting conditions. Minor adjustments were made to brightness, contrast, and overall visual tone where required..

5.4 Titles and Final Presentation

The final stage of editing included the title, subtitles, closing shots, and credits. The Guide's line reinforces the central theme of the film:

“Every choice leaves an echo.”

This provides a clear connection between the fictional journey and the real-life issue of obsession and self-neglect

CHAPTER 6

CONCLUSION

6.1 Final Outcome

“Echoes” was completed as a short film using a simple production setup and a small student team.

The film successfully combines a surreal, reality-blurring narrative with an everyday problem faced by many young people. The shifts between worlds are used not only as a fantasy element but also as a storytelling device to show the consequences of obsession.

The project demonstrates how a short film can communicate a meaningful idea through a combination of screenplay, performance, cinematography, editing, and sound.

6.2 Challenges Faced

Several practical challenges were encountered during production.

Continuity:

Because the same sequence appears repeatedly, actor positions, props, movements, and timing had to remain consistent. Multiple retakes were sometimes required to maintain continuity.

Dialogue Delivery:

Some dialogues required additional takes to achieve clear pronunciation and natural delivery. The repeated lines also had to sound slightly different depending on Vishwa's emotional state.

Limited Equipment:

The production relied on a smartphone camera, tripod, available lighting, and a built-in microphone. This required careful planning to obtain usable footage and audio.

6.3 Learning Outcomes

The project provided practical experience across the complete filmmaking workflow. The major learning outcomes include:

- Understanding how a story idea can be developed into a screenplay.
- Learning the importance of scene planning and continuity.
- Gaining practical experience in directing actors.
- Understanding basic camera framing and shot composition.
- Learning to work within equipment and location limitations.
- Understanding how sound effects can support storytelling.
- Learning video editing using CapCut.
- Understanding basic colour correction.
- Learning how repeated scenes can be edited to create a time-loop effect.
- Developing teamwork, communication, and time-management skills.

6.4 Overall Conclusion

The making of “Echoes” provided the team with practical exposure to the different stages involved in producing a short film. From developing the initial idea and screenplay to shooting, directing, editing, and presenting the final film, the project required both creative thinking and technical execution.

Although the production was completed with limited resources, the team was able to use those limitations as part of the filmmaking process. The gaming montage, the white flash, the hooded Guide, the sound design, and the editing were combined to communicate the central message effectively.

The project ultimately demonstrates that filmmaking is not dependent only on advanced equipment. A clear concept, planned execution, effective teamwork, and thoughtful storytelling can be used to create a meaningful short film..

APPENDICES

Appendix A.1



Appendix A.2 - Footages

